UNCANNY X-MEN: THE DARK PHOENIX SAGA

Details **Originally published** Uncanny X-Men #129–138 (1980) **Publisher** Marvel Comics **Writer** Chris Claremont **Artist** Jack Kirby **Collected in** Uncanny X-Men: Dark Phoenix Saga **Available digitally** Comixology/Marvel Unlimited

Few characters sum up Chris Claremont's journey on *X-Men* quite like Jean Grey. Once the demure Marvel Girl, the sole woman in the original team whose role was to be kidnapped or pined for by the many males on the team, Jean had become the potent host of an intergalactic force of destruction.

No longer the 'best gal-pal' of the 'world's strangest teens', she became the tragic heart of an epic. Intoxicated by power, she abuses it and is forced to pay the price. Jean may have been resurrected – as indeed have many of the characters whose deaths make this list – but the truly great stories cast long shadows.

From here on in the *X-Men* became an unstoppable force, sitting atop the comic charts for two decades, spawning animated series and eventually movies.

A decade earlier, the *Uncanny X-Men* had been threatened with cancellation. Now they rose like a phoenix...







"JEAN GREY BECAME THE TRAGIC HEART OF AN EPIC"